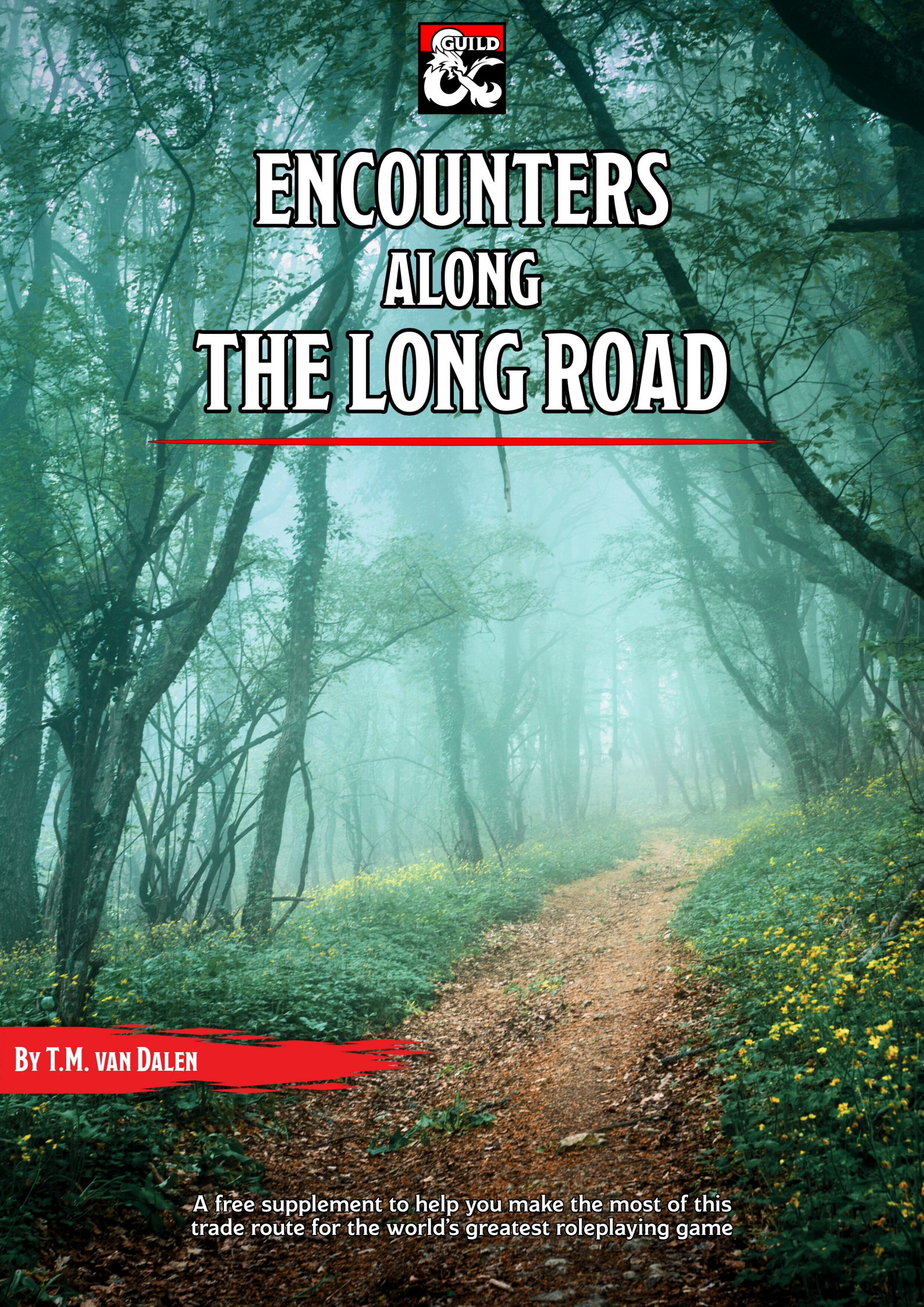

GUILD
ENCOUNTERS
ALONG
THE LONG ROAD
By T.M. van Dalen
A free supplement to help you make the most of this
trade route for the world's greatest roleplaying game

Welcome to the Long Road, one of the North's busiest trade routes. It begins at the gates of Mirabar and continues for hundreds of miles southward through the Dessarin Valley, meeting the High Road just north of Waterdeep.

This free supplement is an extract from Veratrem's Tribal Siege, designed to help you flesh out travel along the Long Road a bit more. In the full adventure, two **hill giants** (MM p.155) have taken over an old trading post, which they are using to ambush traders that move along the road. If you're interested in getting the full story (plus an ambitious young green dragon that has taken over a local tribe of kobolds), check out the full adventure. Readers of this product get a 25% discount!

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The Long Road

Many towns and villages lie along the route of the Long Road, depending on its relative safety. Unfortunately, that safety has been disturbed by the two hill giants and their ambush site.

Random Encounters

When the party travels the Long Road, they could potentially encounter a lot of things, as the arrival of the hill giants has stirred up some trouble in the area. These encounters can happen as often as you like, though you should keep in mind that using too many of them can slow the story down significantly.

Consider checking for a random encounter twice per adventuring day, once during the day and once during a long rest. If you do, roll a d20. If the result is 18 or higher, a random encounter occurs.

The encounters presented below build upon those presented in Chapter 3 of *Storm King's Thunder* (SKT p.68). Feel free to mix and match between the encounters listed there and those below.

Random Encounters on The Long Road

d8	Encounter
1	Bandits
2	City patrols
3	Cloud castle
4	Fire giant pits
5	Goblins
6	Manticores
7	Scared trader
8	Woodland creatures

Adjusting the Encounters

Not all random encounters with monsters need to be resolved through combat. The random encounters presented here do not need to be adjusted for parties with different average party levels.

Of course, you are still free to do so by adjusting the type or number of monsters that the characters encounter.



Bandits

The characters encounter a gang of bandits. The gang consists of a **bandit captain** (MM p.344) and 1d6 + 3 **bandits** (MM p.343), all at half of their maximum hit points.

Originally, the gang had more members, but they were attacked by Rug and Zog (see "Veratrem's Tribal Siege" for more information) and suffered heavy losses.

The gang confronts the party with the captain promising not to attack the party in exchange for a toll (no less than 100 gp worth of treasure). A DC 10 Wisdom (Insight) check reveals that the captain is bluffing and does not feel confident in their chances. Alternatively, a DC 10 Wisdom (Perception) check reveals that the bandits don't look to be in fighting shape. If the characters pay up, the captain bids them a safe journey before departing peacefully. If they don't and a fight breaks out, the captain and bandits attempt to flee after 1 round.

If the characters capture any of the bandits or the captain, they will attempt to trade information about the hill giant settlement for their freedom.

City Patrols

A city patrol is walking towards the characters from the direction of their destination. The City Patrol table shows the makeup of the patrol, depending on the closest town.

City Patrol

Closest Town	Patrol makeup
Amphail	1d4 **nobles** (MM p.348) on horseback
Red Larch	2d4 - 1 **scouts** (MM p.349), young archers
Triboar	1 **knight** (MM p.347), one of the Twelve (SKT p.53), with 2d6 - 1 **guards** (MM p.347)
Wealdham	1d4 **commoners** (MM p.345)
Westbridge	1 **guard** (MM p.347) and 1d4 **commoners** (MM p.345)

The patrol members are friendly towards the party and report that while they are aware that the road is getting more dangerous by the day, they have not seen anything of note on their patrol.

Cloud Castle

Above in the skies, the characters spot a giant castle.

If the characters have encountered Zephyros (SKT p.33) in Chapter 1 of *Storm King's Thunder*, it is his castle and they can recognize it without effort. If the characters have some way to signal to Zephyros, stairs made of clouds begin to form underneath the castle and descend toward them. Zephyros is friendly and can offer advice, but is not traveling in the direction that the characters wish to go and does not offer to take them. He sticks to the warning he received from the planar entities he spoke with using the *contact other plane* spell.

In case the characters *haven't* met Zephyros, the castle poses no threat and ignores them as it slowly drifts away from them.

Fire Giant Pits

The characters come across a site near some low hills where fire giants have recovered a fragment of the Vonindod. There is no trace of the giants, but near the two 30-foot-wide, 20-foot-deep craters are two toppled statues of dwarves.

The first is depicted with a large shield, while the second is holding a warhammer.

A DC 12 Intelligence (Investigation) check reveals religious symbols, indicating that this might have been a site of special spiritual importance.

Goblins

A group of 1 **goblin boss** (MM p.166) with 2d4 **goblins** (MM p.166) attempt to surprise the characters.

It has been hard for them to find food in the area since the arrival of the hill giants and they are starving. They fight till the death.

Manticores

A group of 1d3 **manticores** come down from the sky to attack the party.

Scared Trader

The party encounters a scared trader running their way. The trader, Kogren Visk (LG male Tethyrian human), is in shock and the characters will have to find a way to calm him down before they can get some answers out of him.

When they do, the Kogren tells them he was attacked by hill giants, who took all of his wares and his horse. Kogren is too shaken to remember much about the encounter in detail, but can describe the general location of the hill giant settlement.

Woodland Creatures

Rounding a corner in the road, the characters come upon a place when a pristine forest stream runs closely to the path.

Around the stream are 2d6 **elk**, 1d10 **badgers**, 3d12 **frogs**, 1d4 **tressym** and other small woodland creatures. The beasts aren't hostile and flee if attacked.

What's Next?

Enjoyed the encounters here? Why not check out Veratrem's Tribal Siege with a 25% discount to get the full story or sign up to my mailing list.